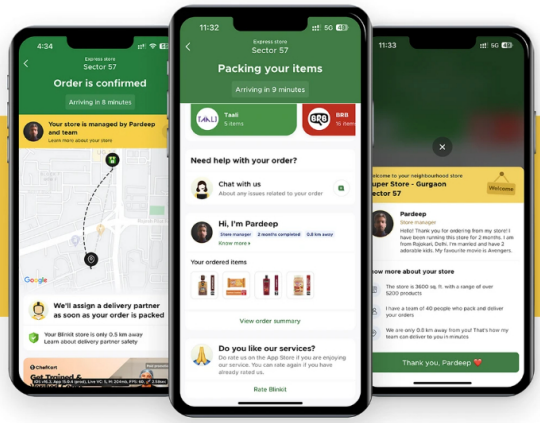
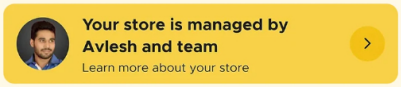
Humanizing the experience



The challenge

Redesign the store manager widget on the Blinkit app to build a connection between Blinkit customers and their store managers.



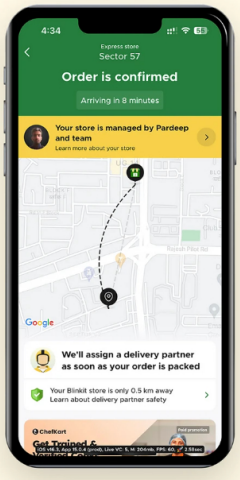
Understanding the challenge

Why would customers care about their store managers while shopping online? I tried to build a connection between the **physical and digital world** and realized that in the physical world, customers usually interact with store staff in supermarkets or kirana stores when:

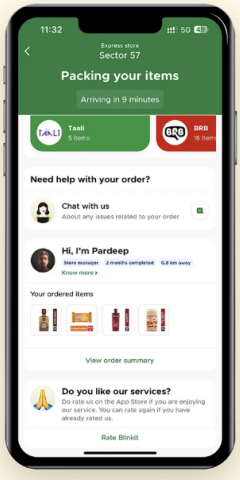
- they have quality concerns
- price-related issues
- need assistance with navigation

This insight helped me uncover the opportunity to create a similar interaction in the digital world.

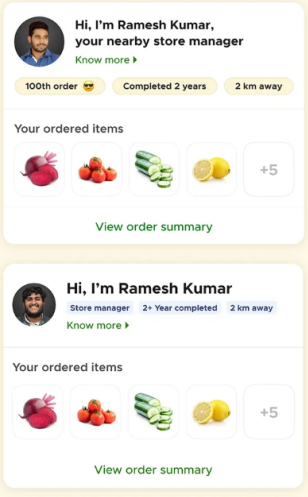
Old vs New widget



Old widget design



New widget live on the app



Design considerations | Failed approaches

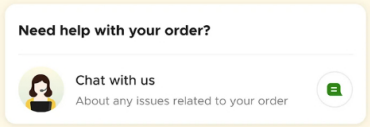
Different design options were explored to build empathy towards store managers among Blinkit customers.

1 Identifying the major point of interaction between a customer and staff in a store?

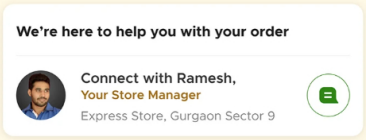
Product related issues; quality concerns, offers, price, refunds, other product related concerns

- How might we facilitate communication between users and their store managers for quality or any product-related concerns?
- Alternatively, can we create a perception of connecting users with their store managers on chat support? Or can we connect them with store managers on call support but that would require another chain of process and training which can be a long term goal
- If customers have any issues, the bot could transfer them to a customer care executive who could play the role of their store manager, thus creating a perception of personal interaction.

Previous widget for chat support



Perception of connecting with the store manager



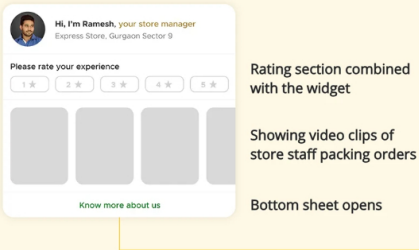
However, I questioned whether creating a false perception would align with Blinkit's and my values and decided to explore other options. Also, there were technical barriers and training procedure while implementing this idea.

2 Creating emotional impact with the use of images and videos

Images can create a stronger emotional impact compared to icons, making it easier for users to connect

Icons can be replaced with images that people can connect with.

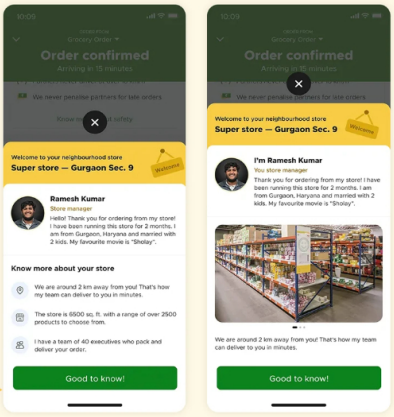
Blinkit's ability to deliver orders within 10 minutes has generated buzz, and showcasing short video clips of store staff packing orders can highlight the effort that goes into achieving this quick delivery time.



Rating section combined with the widget

Showing video clips of store staff packing orders

Bottom sheet opens

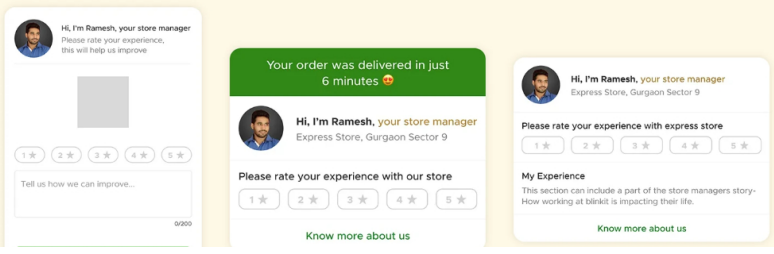


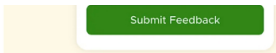
Old design | Iteration

We were unable to implement this solution due to constraints in terms of engineering bandwidth, sourcing images/videos.

3 Customers care about the quality of products they get

Communicate that providing ratings for store managers matters as it would help the platform deliver better service.





4 Customers care most about their order

Combining the store manager widget with order summary and changing the copy to create a personal connection

Old copy

"Your store is managed by Avlesh and team"

vs

New copy

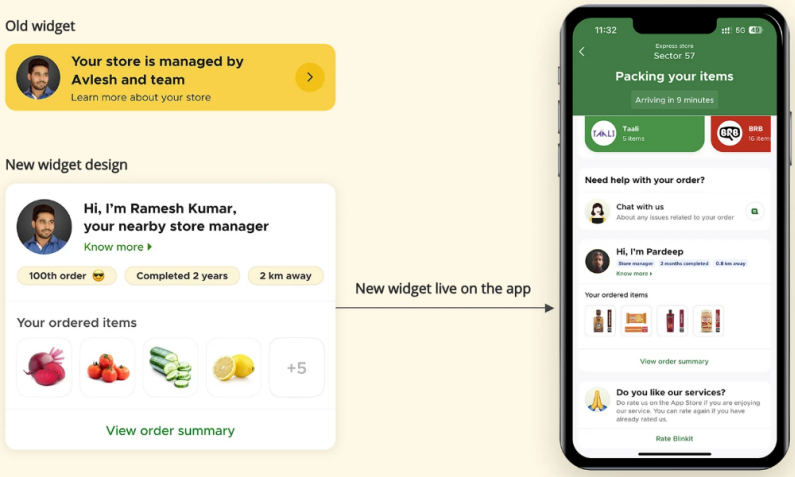
"Hi, I'm Avlesh Sharma, your nearby store manager"

"Your store is managed by Avlesh and team" may come across as more distant and impersonal.

It emphasizes the collective effort of a team, but may not create the same level of personal connection as the new copy.

It creates a personal connection with the customer and makes the store manager more relatable.

Using the first-person perspective ("I'm Avlesh"), creates a sense personalization.



Learnings

This was my first task after joining Blinkit

- Failure is like a seed: It's a starting point for growth. My previous ideas, even if they didn't yield immediate success, are not wasted. They can be valuable in the long term, as they are a stepping stone for new ideas. Failure
- Learnt the significance of multiple levels of feedback and iterations, and how they are necessary for improvement.
- Understood the importance of micro-level thinking and decision-making
- Power of copy in creating a significant impact.
- I have also gained insights into practical aspects such as engineering bandwidth and the importance of sourcing information effectively, as this project is live.